MABBIEFX

LARZ

User Manual

MabbieFX Audio

Software instrument for sub-drops, low-frequency effects, and cinematic sound design

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1. Welcome to LARZ

LARZ is a focused software instrument for creating sub-drops, kick-like sine tones, bass accents, and other pitched low-frequency effects. Its sound engine combines sine-wave voices with editable Pitch and Amp envelopes, giving you direct control over how a sound changes in frequency and loudness over time.

Use LARZ to build low-frequency transitions, add weight to impacts, create descending tones, or design short, tuned sounds that complement drums and other musical elements.

Rather than a general-purpose synthesizer, LARZ is designed around a simple approach: trigger a sound with MIDI, shape its pitch contour, and control its amplitude envelope.

What you can shape

- **Pitch:** Draw a frequency curve that moves through time, from sharp high-to-low drops to slower, more gradual movements.
- **Amp:** Set how quickly the sound rises, falls to its Sustain level, holds, and fades to silence.
- **Key Track:** Choose whether MIDI notes transpose the sound relative to a selected Root Note.
- **Start Phase:** Set the sine oscillator's starting phase for each triggered voice.
- **Gain:** Adjust the instrument's output level.
- **View Length:** Change the time span displayed in the envelope graphs without changing the sound itself.

LARZ is a one-shot instrument. A MIDI note-on starts the sound, and the sound plays through its amplitude envelope. Releasing the MIDI note does not stop or shorten it.

2. Quick Start

Follow these steps to create your first LARZ sound.

Step 1: Insert LARZ

Open a DAW or other compatible host that supports software instruments. Insert LARZ on a MIDI or instrument track, using the plugin format supported by your host: Audio Unit (AU) or VST3 on macOS, or VST3 on Windows.

Check the host's track and instrument routing so MIDI can reach LARZ and its stereo audio output can reach an audible destination.

Step 2: Trigger a sound

Create a MIDI note in the track's MIDI region or play a note from a connected MIDI controller.

A note-on triggers a new sound. You do not need to hold the key until the sound finishes. MIDI note-off is ignored, and the sound continues through its programmed amplitude envelope.

Start with the default settings to hear the basic descending sine tone.

Step 3: Adjust the Amp envelope

Use the Amp graph or the Attack, Decay, Sustain, Hold, and Release controls to change the sound's shape.

For a shorter, more immediate sound, reduce the envelope timings. For a longer effect, increase the relevant stages.

Listen for the difference between the initial impact, the level after Decay, the timed Hold stage, and the final fade to silence.

Step 4: Shape the Pitch envelope

The Pitch graph controls oscillator frequency over time.

Move its nodes to change when the pitch drops and how far it falls. A quick descent can create a tight, percussive effect; a slower descent can produce a longer cinematic transition.

Step 5: Check the level and triggering behavior

Use Gain to set the instrument's output level. MIDI velocity also affects the amplitude of each triggered voice.

If you want incoming MIDI notes to transpose the sound, enable Key Track and set the Root Note to the MIDI note you want to use as the reference. Otherwise, leave Key Track off to keep the pitch contour independent of incoming note numbers.

3. How LARZ Works

3.1 MIDI triggering and one-shot playback

LARZ is a MIDI instrument that generates audio when it receives a MIDI note-on message.

Each note-on triggers a voice, which follows the programmed Pitch and Amp envelopes. The sound is not controlled by how long the MIDI note is held.

MIDI note-off does not stop, release, or shorten a LARZ sound. The Amp envelope always follows its programmed sequence through Attack, Decay, Hold, and Release.

To change the sound's duration, adjust its envelope settings rather than the length of the MIDI note.

3.2 Pitch and amplitude

Each triggered voice uses a sine wave as its sound source.

The **Pitch envelope** determines the oscillator frequency over time. It can create a descending drop, a rising sweep, a stable tone, or another frequency movement formed by the available nodes.

The **Amp envelope** determines the sound's loudness over time. It shapes the initial attack, the movement from peak to Sustain, the timed Hold stage, and the final fade to silence.

These two envelopes work together. A sound may descend quickly in pitch while fading slowly in amplitude, or hold a nearly constant pitch while producing a short, kick-like impact.

3.3 Velocity

MIDI velocity scales the amplitude of a triggered voice. Different note velocities can therefore produce different output levels.

Velocity does not change the Pitch envelope's programmed frequency nodes. For consistent loudness when comparing sounds, use similar MIDI velocities and avoid changing Gain between comparisons.

3.4 Voice count and overlapping sounds

LARZ supports up to **eight overlapping voices**.

This allows multiple triggered sounds to continue playing while new MIDI notes arrive. If a new note arrives when all eight voices are active, LARZ uses round-robin voice allocation. An existing voice may be cut off to make room for the new one.

If a sound is unexpectedly shortened during dense MIDI passages, check whether more than eight voices are overlapping.

3.5 Key Track

Key Track determines whether incoming MIDI note numbers affect pitch.

- **Off:** Incoming MIDI note numbers do not transpose the sound. The Pitch envelope follows its programmed frequency curve.
- **On:** The incoming MIDI note shifts the voice's pitch in semitone steps relative to Root Note.

Root Note is the reference MIDI note. Notes above it transpose the sound upward, and notes below it transpose the sound downward.

When Key Track is enabled, changing the incoming MIDI note changes the pitch relationship while retaining the shape of the programmed Pitch envelope.

4. Interface Overview



Figure 1. The LARZ interface with the default settings.

The LARZ interface centers on two envelope graphs, an on/off Key Track control, and four rotary controls.

4.1 Pitch graph

The Pitch graph displays oscillator frequency against time. Its horizontal axis represents time, while its vertical axis represents frequency in hertz (Hz).

The graph is controlled by pitch nodes. Each node specifies a time and frequency, and LARZ interpolates logarithmically between neighboring nodes.

Use the graph to determine how quickly a sound falls or rises, where a change in direction occurs, and what frequency the sound reaches at each point in the contour.

The default Pitch envelope contains four nodes:

Node	Time	Frequency
1	0 ms	400 Hz
2	40 ms	100 Hz
3	250 ms	55 Hz
4	1500 ms	40 Hz

The first node is fixed at 0 ms. The graph supports a minimum of two and a maximum of sixteen nodes, with each node's frequency limited to 20–2000 Hz.

After the last node, its frequency continues until the voice ends. The oscillator therefore does not automatically stop or return to the original pitch when it reaches the last node.

Editing pitch nodes

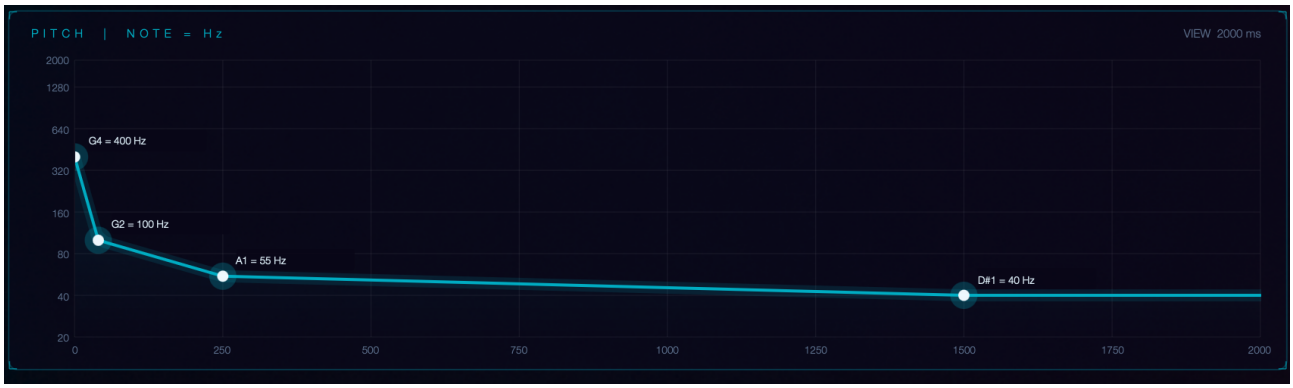


Figure 2. The Pitch graph with the four default nodes.

- **Move a node:** Drag a node to change its time and frequency.
- **Add a node:** Double-click an empty area of the Pitch graph.
- **Remove a node:** Double-click a removable node.
- **Keep the first node:** The node at time 0 ms cannot be moved away from time zero or removed.
- **Respect the node limits:** The graph supports 2–16 pitch nodes. You cannot reduce the curve below two nodes or add more than sixteen.

The precise time placement of a node determines when its frequency value is reached. Its frequency determines the pitch at that point in the sound.

For a simple sub-drop, begin with a high initial frequency and lower subsequent nodes. For a more complex contour, add nodes to control intermediate stages rather than relying on one long descent.

4.2 Amp graph

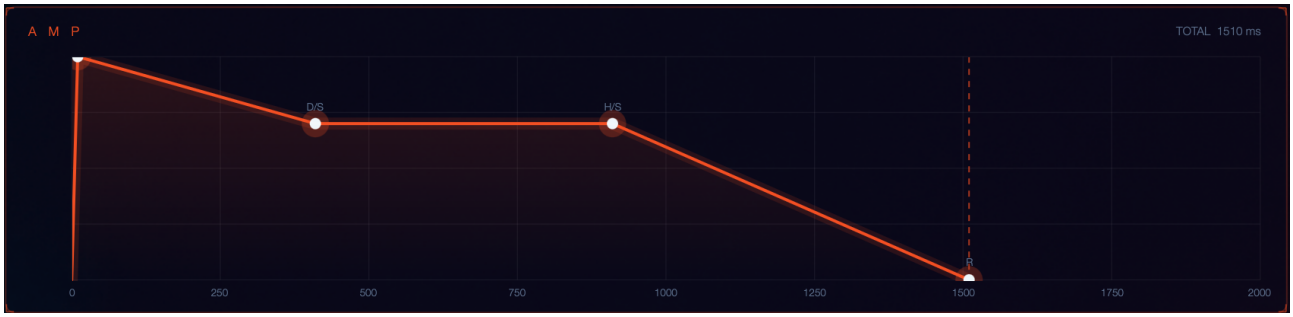


Figure 3. The Amp graph with the default envelope and its four handles.

The Amp graph displays loudness over time. It represents the same time view used by the Pitch graph, but it controls amplitude rather than oscillator frequency.

The amplitude contour has four main stages:

1. **Attack:** The amplitude rises from zero to its peak.
2. **Decay:** The amplitude moves from its peak to the Sustain level.
3. **Hold:** The amplitude stays at the Sustain level for a specified time.
4. **Release:** The amplitude falls from the Sustain level to silence.

The Amp graph has four envelope handles:

Handle	What it represents	What it adjusts
Peak	End of Attack	Attack timing
Sustain	End of Decay	Decay timing and Sustain level
End of Hold	End of the timed Hold stage, at the same Sustain level	Hold timing
End of Release	End of the envelope, at zero amplitude	Release timing

Drag the handles to adjust the corresponding envelope timing and, where applicable, the Sustain level. Changes remain within the documented control ranges.

The Hold stage is a timed part of a one-shot contour. It does not wait for you to release a MIDI note. After Hold finishes, Release begins automatically and the sound fades to silence.

4.3 Key Track control

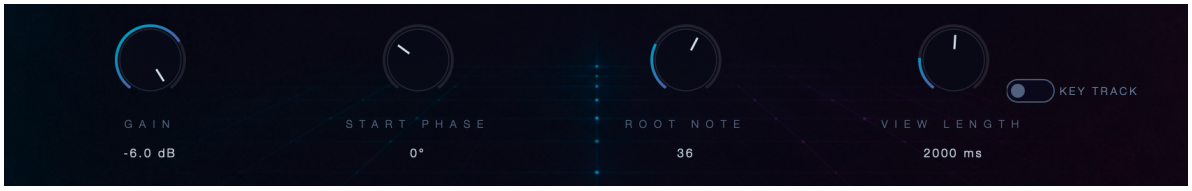


Figure 4. The four rotary controls and the Key Track switch.

Key Track is an on/off control.

When it is off, MIDI note numbers do not transpose the programmed sound. When it is on, the difference in semitones between the incoming MIDI note and Root Note determines the pitch shift.

Root Note acts as a reference rather than an independent pitch envelope. The Pitch graph still defines how frequency evolves over time.

4.4 Rotary controls

LARZ has four rotary controls:

- **Gain:** Sets the instrument's output level.
- **Start Phase:** Sets the sine oscillator's starting phase for each triggered voice.
- **Root Note:** Selects the reference MIDI note used when Key Track is enabled.
- **View Length:** Sets the horizontal time span displayed in both envelope graphs.

Double-clicking a rotary control returns that control to its default value.

4.5 View Length

View Length changes how much time is visible across the Pitch and Amp graphs.

A shorter view focuses on the initial part of the envelopes. A longer view shows more of their timeline, which can help when editing slower pitch movements or longer amplitude contours.

View Length changes only the displayed time range. It does not change envelope timing, pitch-node timing, or the sound's duration.

If the graph looks different after changing View Length, this reflects the graph's displayed time scale rather than a change to the programmed sound.

5. Controls Reference

The following table lists every primary control, its documented range, unit, and default value.

Control	Range	Unit	Default	Purpose
Attack	0–500	ms	10 ms	Time for the amplitude envelope to rise from zero to its peak.
Decay	1–4000	ms	400 ms	Time for the amplitude envelope to move from peak to the Sustain level.
Sustain	0–1 (0–100%)	Ratio / percentage	0.70 (70%)	Amplitude level reached after Decay and held during the timed Hold stage.
Hold	0–4000	ms	500 ms	Time spent at the Sustain level after Decay and before Release.
Release	1–4000	ms	600 ms	Time for the amplitude envelope to fall from Sustain to silence.
Key Track	Off/On	State	Off	Enables or disables MIDI-note-based pitch transposition.
Root Note	MIDI note 0–127	MIDI note number	36	Reference note for Key Track; notes above or below it transpose up or down by semitones.
Start Phase	0–360	degrees	0 degrees	Sets the sine oscillator's starting phase for each triggered voice.
Gain	-48 to +12	dB	-6 dB	Sets the instrument's output level.
View Length	500–8000	ms	2000 ms	Sets the horizontal time span shown in both envelope graphs; it does not change envelope timing.

5.1 Understanding the Amp parameters

Attack controls the initial rise from silence to the peak. Short Attack times create a more immediate onset, while longer times produce a gradual rise.

Decay controls how long the amplitude takes to move from the peak to Sustain. Shorter Decay times reach the Sustain level sooner; longer times maintain the initial peak for more of the contour.

Sustain sets the amplitude level reached after Decay. A lower value produces a quieter Hold stage, while a higher value keeps more of the initial level.

Hold determines how long the sound remains at the Sustain level before Release begins. Set Hold to zero for no timed plateau.

Release controls the fade from Sustain to silence. Shorter Release times create a quicker ending; longer Release times create a more gradual tail.

These stages form a timed one-shot envelope. MIDI note length and note-off do not control when the stages advance.

5.2 Understanding Key Track and Root Note

Key Track must be enabled for incoming MIDI note numbers to transpose the sound.

When enabled, Root Note defines the reference pitch. An incoming MIDI note above Root Note shifts the programmed pitch upward, while a note below Root Note shifts it downward.

The actual frequency movement still comes from the Pitch envelope. Key Track applies the semitone transposition associated with the incoming note; it does not replace or redraw the envelope.

5.3 Understanding Start Phase

Start Phase sets the sine oscillator's starting phase for each triggered voice. Its range is 0–360 degrees, with a default of 0 degrees.

Changing this value adjusts the phase at which a voice begins its sine-wave cycle. It does not change the Pitch envelope's node frequencies or the Amp envelope's timing.

5.4 Understanding Gain

Gain adjusts LARZ's output level. Its range is -48 to +12 dB, with a default of -6 dB.

Use Gain to place the sound appropriately in a mix or to compare different sound-design settings at a consistent level. Output level also depends on the programmed Amp envelope and incoming MIDI velocity.

5.5 Understanding View Length

View Length controls the time span visible in both graphs. Its range is 500–8000 ms, with a default of 2000 ms.

Use a shorter view when editing fast transients and a longer view when working on extended pitch drops. Changing this setting does not stretch, compress, or otherwise alter the sound.

5.6 Pitch envelope reference

The Pitch envelope supports 2–16 nodes. The first node remains fixed at 0 ms.

Property	Specification
Frequency range per node	20–2000 Hz
Number of nodes	2–16
First-node time	Fixed at 0 ms
Interpolation between nodes	Logarithmic frequency interpolation
Frequency after final node	Continues at the final node's frequency until the voice ends
Default node 1	0 ms, 400 Hz
Default node 2	40 ms, 100 Hz
Default node 3	250 ms, 55 Hz
Default node 4	1500 ms, 40 Hz

The logarithmic interpolation determines how frequency moves between nodes. The transition is therefore not a simple linear change in frequency measured in hertz.

6. Sound-Design Walkthroughs

The following recipes are **suggested starting points, not factory presets**. They use the documented parameter ranges and are intended to help you explore LARZ's core functions. Adjust the values to suit the arrangement and the role of the sound in your project.

For consistency when comparing results, start with a similar MIDI velocity and output level.

6.1 Fast Falling Sub-Drop

Goal: Create a short, direct descending tone for a transition, impact layer, or low-frequency accent.

Suggested Amp settings

Control	Suggested value
Attack	2 ms
Decay	250 ms
Sustain	0.20 (20%)
Hold	80 ms
Release	250 ms
Gain	-6 dB
Key Track	Off
Start Phase	0 degrees
View Length	1000 ms

Suggested Pitch nodes

Node	Time	Frequency
1	0 ms	500 Hz
2	35 ms	120 Hz
3	180 ms	50 Hz
4	500 ms	35 Hz

How to build it

1. Enter the suggested Amp values.
2. Edit the Pitch nodes to form the descending curve.
3. Trigger a MIDI note and listen to the movement from the initial tone into the low-frequency tail.
4. Shorten Release if the effect occupies too much space after the transient. Adjust the Pitch nodes if the drop reaches its lowest frequency too quickly or too slowly.

What to listen for

Listen for a clear initial attack followed by an obvious downward pitch movement. The reduced Sustain level and relatively short Hold keep the sound from lingering at a high amplitude.

If the sound feels too abrupt, lengthen Attack slightly or smooth the Pitch contour by adjusting node timing. If it feels too long, shorten the relevant envelope stages rather than the MIDI note.

6.2 Longer Cinematic Drop

Goal: Create a slower descent for cinematic transitions, dramatic builds, or large impact layers.

Suggested Amp settings

Control	Suggested value
Attack	30 ms
Decay	1200 ms
Sustain	0.45 (45%)
Hold	900 ms
Release	1600 ms
Gain	-9 dB
Key Track	Off
Start Phase	0 degrees
View Length	5000 ms

Suggested Pitch nodes

Node	Time	Frequency
1	0 ms	700 Hz
2	120 ms	300 Hz
3	700 ms	100 Hz
4	2000 ms	35 Hz

How to build it

1. Set the Amp envelope to allow a slower initial rise, a longer Decay, and an extended Release.
2. Place the Pitch nodes to create a gradual downward movement across the sound.
3. Trigger the sound and listen to the full descent.
4. Move the middle Pitch nodes to change where the drop accelerates or slows down.
5. Increase or reduce the Hold stage to change how long the sound remains at the Sustain level before fading.

What to listen for

The goal is a sense of movement rather than a short, percussive strike. The Pitch curve should evolve long enough to be heard as a transition, while the Amp envelope controls how much of that movement remains audible.

If the sound becomes too prominent in the mix, lower Gain or reduce Sustain. If the tail feels truncated, lengthen Release or confirm that another note has not caused voice stealing.

6.3 Short Kick-Like Thump

Goal: Create a compact, percussive sine tone that can complement a kick or serve as a low-frequency impact layer.

Suggested Amp settings

Control	Suggested value
Attack	0 ms
Decay	110 ms
Sustain	0.05 (5%)
Hold	0 ms
Release	120 ms
Gain	-6 dB
Key Track	Off
Start Phase	0 degrees
View Length	500 ms

Suggested Pitch nodes

Node	Time	Frequency
1	0 ms	180 Hz
2	25 ms	70 Hz
3	100 ms	45 Hz

How to build it

1. Use a very short Attack and a short Decay.
2. Set Sustain low and Hold to zero to reduce the time spent at a steady amplitude.
3. Create a sharp downward pitch movement near the start of the sound.
4. Trigger the sound alongside a kick or other transient and adjust Gain to fit the balance.

What to listen for

Listen for a compact low-frequency onset rather than a long resonant tail. The rapid pitch descent provides the sense of impact, while the Amp envelope determines how quickly the level falls away.

If the result feels too tonal or extended, adjust the pitch movement and shorten the applicable amplitude stages. If it feels too quiet after the initial transient, try a higher Sustain value or a different

Decay time.

This recipe creates a kick-like sine tone; it does not turn LARZ into a full drum synthesizer.

6.4 Tuned Bass Accent

Goal: Create a low-frequency accent that can follow the notes of a musical part.

Suggested Amp settings

Control	Suggested value
Attack	5 ms
Decay	180 ms
Sustain	0.55 (55%)
Hold	300 ms
Release	250 ms
Gain	-6 dB
Key Track	On
Root Note	36
Start Phase	0 degrees
View Length	1500 ms

Suggested Pitch nodes

Node	Time	Frequency
1	0 ms	100 Hz
2	100 ms	70 Hz
3	400 ms	55 Hz

How to build it

1. Enable Key Track.
2. Set Root Note to the MIDI note you want to use as your reference.
3. Enter the suggested Pitch and Amp settings.
4. Trigger different MIDI note numbers and compare the resulting pitches.
5. Adjust Root Note and the Pitch envelope to fit the tonal role of the accent.

What to listen for

Listen for a repeatable pitch relationship as you play different MIDI notes. Key Track transposes the programmed frequency contour in semitone steps relative to Root Note.

The suggested Root Note of 36 is only a starting point. Choose the reference that fits your MIDI material. If the sound does not respond to changing MIDI note numbers, check that Key Track is on.

Because every note-on triggers a one-shot sound, MIDI note length does not determine how long the accent plays. Use the Amp envelope to set its duration.

7. Saving and Recalling Your Work

LARZ's settings are part of the instrument instance in your host session. The normal way to retain and recall a LARZ sound is to save the DAW project or session containing that instance.

Saving a sound

1. Adjust the Pitch envelope, Amp envelope, Key Track, Root Note, Start Phase, Gain, and any other controls you have used.
2. Save the host project or session using your DAW's normal save procedure.
3. Keep the saved project with any other media or dependencies your host requires.

Recalling a sound

1. Open the saved project or session.
2. Locate the track containing LARZ.
3. Check that the instrument instance and its settings have been retained by the host.

For project-specific saving and recovery instructions, refer to your DAW's documentation.

This manual describes saving and recalling the instrument instance through the host project. It does not assume that LARZ includes a separate preset-file browser or standalone preset-management system.

8. Troubleshooting

The following checks are host-neutral. The exact location of routing, MIDI, and monitoring settings depends on your DAW or other compatible host.

8.1 No sound

Check the instrument track.

Confirm that LARZ is inserted on a MIDI or instrument track and that the track is configured to send MIDI to the instrument.

Check MIDI input.

Play a MIDI note or create a note in the track's MIDI region. Confirm that the host is sending MIDI to the correct instrument instance.

Remember that LARZ responds to note-on events. Simply playing back an audio track without MIDI triggering will not trigger the instrument.

Check track and host monitoring.

Verify that the relevant track is enabled for playback and that any monitoring or playback settings required by your host are configured appropriately.

Check Gain.

LARZ Gain ranges from -48 to +12 dB and defaults to -6 dB. Raise Gain if the output level is too low, while keeping the host's output level at a suitable setting.

Check the Amp envelope.

Review Attack, Decay, Sustain, Hold, and Release. A very low Sustain setting, combined with short envelope stages, may make the sound difficult to hear. Try the default Amp values as a reference.

Check Key Track and Root Note.

Key Track affects pitch, not whether MIDI notes trigger a voice. If the sound is present but at an unexpected pitch, review the Key Track state and Root Note.

Check output routing.

Confirm that the instrument track's stereo audio output is routed to an audible destination in the host. Check relevant track levels and mute settings as well.

8.2 The pitch is unexpected

Inspect the Pitch graph.

Check the time and frequency of each pitch node. The first node must remain at 0 ms, and all node frequencies must stay within 20–2000 Hz.

Check Key Track.

When Key Track is on, incoming MIDI note numbers transpose the sound relative to Root Note. When it is off, changing MIDI note numbers does not transpose the sound.

Check Root Note.

If Key Track is enabled, make sure Root Note is set to the intended reference MIDI note. A different reference changes the pitch relationship between incoming MIDI notes and the programmed contour.

Remember the final-node behavior.

After the last Pitch node, frequency continues at the final node's frequency until the voice ends. Reaching the last node does not stop the oscillator or reset it to the first node's frequency.

Check the displayed time scale.

View Length changes the visible timeline, not the Pitch envelope itself. A graph may look more compressed or expanded after adjusting View Length even though the sound has not changed.

8.3 Sounds overlap unexpectedly or are cut short

LARZ supports up to eight overlapping voices. When all eight are active, a new note triggers round-robin voice allocation, and an existing voice may be cut off.

If you hear unexpected interruptions:

1. Check how many MIDI notes are triggering while previous sounds are still playing.
2. Reduce the amount of overlap in the MIDI performance where appropriate.
3. Shorten the Amp envelope if the arrangement does not require long tails.
4. Test the sound with fewer overlapping notes.

MIDI note length does not stop a voice early. If a sound is cut off during a dense passage, check voice overlap as well as the programmed envelope.

8.4 The sound ends too quickly or lasts too long

Review the Amp stages in order:

- Increase or decrease Attack to adjust the initial rise.
- Change Decay to control the transition from peak to Sustain.
- Adjust Sustain to set the amplitude level after Decay.
- Change Hold to control the timed plateau.
- Adjust Release to change the final fade to silence.

If the pitch drop itself feels too fast or too slow, adjust the Pitch node positions instead. View Length is only a display setting and does not alter either envelope.

8.5 MIDI note length does not change the sound

This is expected behavior.

LARZ is a one-shot instrument. MIDI note-on starts the sound, and the Amp envelope continues through Attack, Decay, Hold, and Release. MIDI note-off is ignored.

To shorten or lengthen the sound, adjust the Amp envelope settings.

8.6 LARZ does not appear in the host

Check the plugin format your host supports. On macOS, LARZ is available as AU and VST3. On Windows, LARZ is available as VST3 only, so a host that supports only AU or AAX will not list it on Windows.

Confirm that LARZ is installed in its default location for your platform (see Section 9.2, Installation), then rescan plugins in your host (see Section 9.2, Plugin scanning). If the plugin is still missing, restart the host and check that the host's plugin scan paths include the default folder.

9. Specifications and Release Information

9.1 Product specifications

Item	Specification
Product	LARZ
Manufacturer / brand	MabbieFX Audio
Product type	MIDI software instrument / synthesizer for low-frequency effects
Primary uses	Sub-drops, kick-like sine tones, bass accents, cinematic transitions, and sound-design elements
Sound source	Sine-wave voices
Sound shaping	Editable Pitch and Amp envelopes
Instrument triggering	MIDI note-on
MIDI note-off behavior	Ignored; the one-shot sound continues through its programmed envelope
Velocity response	Velocity scales voice amplitude
Maximum overlapping voices	8
Voice allocation when all voices are active	Round-robin; an existing voice may be cut off
Pitch transposition	Optional Key Track, referenced to Root Note
Audio input	None
Audio output	Stereo
MIDI output	None
Plugin formats	macOS: Audio Unit (AU) and VST3. Windows: VST3
Version and release date	1.0.6 / October 16, 2026
System requirements	macOS 11 Big Sur or later on Apple Silicon (Mac mini M1 base or better), or Windows 10/11 64-bit on an equivalent PC; see Section 9.2
Official website	MabbieFX.com/LARZ
Support contact	support@mabbiefx.com
Copyright and license	© 2026 MabbieFX Audio. All rights reserved.

9.2 About / Release Information

Product: LARZ **Manufacturer:** MabbieFX Audio
Version and release date: 1.0.6 / October 16, 2026
Official website: MabbieFX.com/LARZ
Support contact: support@mabbiefx.com

System requirements

LARZ is built for both Mac and Windows. The reference system for macOS is the base-model Mac mini with the Apple M1 chip. The Windows column lists an equivalent PC. Systems at or above these references are supported.

Item	macOS	Windows
Reference system	Mac mini (M1), base model: 8-core CPU, 8 GB memory	Equivalent PC: 64-bit quad-core or better CPU, such as Intel Core i5-11400 or AMD Ryzen 5 5600 class, 8 GB memory
Operating system	macOS 11 Big Sur or later	Windows 10 or Windows 11, 64-bit
Processor	Apple Silicon (M1 or newer)	x86-64 (Intel or AMD)
Memory	8 GB or more	8 GB or more
Plugin formats	AU and VST3	VST3
Host	Any AU or VST3 host that supports software instruments	Any VST3 host that supports software instruments
Audio output	Core Audio device	ASIO driver recommended for low latency

Installation

The installer places LARZ in the standard plugin folders for your platform. Hosts look for plugins in these folders by default.

Platform and format	Default location
macOS, Audio Unit (AU)	`/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components/LARZ.component`
macOS, VST3	`/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3/LARZ.vst3`
Windows, VST3	`C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3\LARZ.vst3`

On macOS, a plugin installed for the current user only lives in the matching folder inside your user Library: `~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/`.

Plugin scanning

1. Close your host completely after installing LARZ, then open it again.
2. Most hosts scan for new plugins at launch. If LARZ does not appear, open the host's plugin manager or preferences and run a rescan.
3. If the host skipped or blocklisted LARZ during an earlier scan, clear that entry (or reset the blocklist) and rescan.
4. Confirm that the host's plugin scan paths include the default folder for your platform listed above.
5. Insert LARZ on a MIDI or instrument track, not on an audio track.

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9.3 Important usage notes

- LARZ is a one-shot instrument: MIDI note-off does not stop or shorten a triggered sound.
- The sound's programmed Pitch and Amp envelopes determine its evolution over time.
- Velocity scales the amplitude of each triggered voice.
- Key Track must be enabled for incoming MIDI note numbers to transpose the sound.
- View Length changes only the graph's displayed time span.
- A maximum of eight voices can overlap; additional notes may cause an active voice to be cut off.
- System requirements, default install locations, and plugin scanning steps for Mac and Windows are listed in Section 9.2.

10. Closing Notes

LARZ is built to make low-frequency sound design direct and accessible. Use the Pitch graph to shape the movement of a sine tone, use the Amp graph to define its one-shot contour, and use MIDI triggering to place the resulting sound in your arrangement.

Start with the default settings, make one adjustment at a time, and listen to how each change affects the impact, pitch movement, and tail. Small changes in node placement or envelope timing can lead to very different results.

For the most consistent results, save the host project containing your LARZ instance and keep a record of the settings you use in important sessions.

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